

SHAWN SUTHERLAND

R U B Y O N R A I L S D E V E L O P E R

CONTACT

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Portfolio: [sasutherland.github.io](https://github.com/sasutherland)



EDUCATION

BACHELOR OF ARTS

Saint Mary's University
2006 - 2009

JOURNALISM

Toronto Metro University
2009 - 2011

TECHNICAL WRITING (ONLINE)

Simon Fraser University
2015

FULL-STACK DEVELOPMENT

Le Wagon Amsterdam
2022

KEY SKILLS

Ruby on Rails

RESTful APIs

PostgreSQL

JavaScript and React

UI/UX design (Figma)

Git and GitHub workflows

Agile development

Team / client collaboration

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I'm a **Ruby on Rails web developer** with four years of experience building apps on various platforms. Previously I worked as a technical writer where I wrote, edited, and maintained digital content using an array of tools and programming languages. Since 2022 I've worked as a freelance web developer and teacher at Le Wagon, where I train students how to use Ruby on Rails, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, and SQL. My [portfolio](#) includes apps I have built for my clients, including a social media app for musicians and a tutoring platform for primary school students.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

FREELANCE RUBY ON RAILS DEVELOPER

Freelance / Remote / **2022 – Present**

As a freelancer, I build custom web applications for clients sourced via Bamboe.io. First I help translate their ideas into structured plans on Figma, then we define the scope before I begin delivering the project using Agile methodologies. Projects are version-controlled with GitHub and built with a modern stack (Rails, React, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, Redis, Mapbox, Cloudinary, Bootstrap, Sass, Stimulus). In past projects I have implemented a variety of dynamic features, such as real-time messaging systems, user-generated content (posts and comments), and scheduled notifications. Key responsibilities include:

- UI/UX design and prototyping in Figma.
- Developing full-stack applications with Ruby on Rails.
- Managing databases and backend logic (PostgreSQL).
- Implementing interactive frontend features with JavaScript.
- Client collaboration, scoping, and timeline planning.
- Iterative delivery and progress reporting.

RUBY ON RAILS TEACHER AND LECTURER

Le Wagon / Campuses in Europe and online / **2022 – Present**

I also teach web development at Le Wagon at their various campuses across Europe (in the Netherlands, Belgium, Portugal, etc.) and online. This includes:

- Preparing and giving lectures.
- Guiding students through their daily coding challenges.
- Leading live-coding sessions at the end of the day.
- Ensuring students' progression throughout the course.

Students are trained in Ruby, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS6, PostgreSQL, GitHub, Figma, and Heroku. Additionally, I have taught public workshops and tutorials to help promote the company (for example, showing attendees how to create their first landing page using basic HTML/CSS). During my time at Le Wagon, I've also dedicated myself to further skill development, expanding my proficiency in frameworks and libraries such as React, Vite, Vue, and Angular.

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R U B Y O N R A I L S D E V E L O P E R

MAIN STACK

APIs	Node.js
Bootstrap	PostgreSQL
Cloudinary	Python
CSS	React
Figma	Redis
Git	RSpec
GitHub	Ruby
Heroku	Ruby on Rails
HTML	Sass (SCSS)
JavaScript	SQL
JSON	Stimulus
Kotlin	Ubuntu
Mapbox	UI/UX

ACHIEVEMENTS

CLOUD DIGITAL LEADER

Earned Google Cloud certification as a Cloud Digital Leader, demonstrating in-depth knowledge of the platform.

PROJECTS COMPLETED

Our team at KPMG delivered worldwide Omega and Leapfrog cloud-optimization projects in 2021, saving our clients millions of euros.

ACTIVE MEMBER OF KIVA.ORG

Since 2006, I have made over 100 micro-credit loans to up-and-coming entrepreneurs in the developing world

OTHER EXPERIENCE

TECHNICAL WRITER – MICROSOFT AZURE AND M365

KPMG International / Remote / **2019 – 2022**

At KPMG I helped optimize Azure cloud-based services for our member firms. As the sole technical writer on this project, I created, reviewed, and updated all documentation necessary for several workstreams. This included:

- Writing feasibility studies.
- Developing business cases for suggested upgrades.
- Creating gap analyses between new and existing applications.
- Designing architecture reference documents and user guides.
- Developing proof-of-concepts to validate future state models.

All documentation was written in close collaboration with subject matter experts and product owners. Deliverables were expected to be completed in accordance with our project roadmap and stored for easy access on SharePoint. While our office was in Amstelveen, Netherlands, I worked remotely from Budapest.

TECHNICAL WRITER – TELECOMMUNICATIONS

Nokia Networks / Budapest, Hungary / **2014 – 2017**

At Nokia I created, edited, and updated technical documents for network service providers. My team and I worked in close collaboration with engineers and subject matter experts to ensure that our documentation was up to date. Our responsibilities included:

- Using XML editors to update text, tables, and figures in our documents based on changes to the network portfolio.
- Troubleshooting any errors in our documentation with JIRA.
- Completing projects based on an Agile development model while adhering to publishing deadlines.
- Using CMS tools to plan meetings, store information, archive technical reviews, and encourage best practices across departments.
- Ensuring our documents were DITA-compliant to make them easier to read and to allow for content reuse and single-sourcing.

REFERENCES

ROEL DE JONG

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JOHN GUDELIS

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